

Chi Danh Dao (Dan)

Contact Information

Institution: Queen's University
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Personal Information: Canadian–Vietnamese Dual Citizen

Education

- **Queen's University, Canada**
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics , 2021–Present, GPA: 4.1
- **University of New Brunswick, Canada**
M.A. in Economics, 2019–2021, GPA: 4.3
- **Tan Tao University, Vietnam**
B.Sc. in Finance and Accounting, Cum Laude, 2011–2015

Affiliation

- **Bank Of Canada, Canada**
External academic consultant, 2026–

Research Projects

- *Profiles of Debt: Revolving Behavior and Financial Well-Being*

Abstract: Using microdata from the Bank of Canada's Digital Wallet and Payment Trends survey, this paper examines the financial well-being and consumption of credit card users who carry revolving balances (Revolvers). Despite tighter liquidity constraints, Revolvers exhibit financial positions and comfort comparable to Convenience users, providing limited evidence that revolving debt alone signals financial distress. Synthetic-cohort estimates show that Revolvers consume more early in life but experience slower consumption growth during prime working years, producing a compressed hump-shaped profile. I develop a model that reconciles these patterns by allowing Revolvers to be relatively impatient in consumption decisions but relatively patient in investment decisions.

- *Rewards, Credit Access, and Inequality in the Credit Card Market (Job Market Paper)*

Abstract: Credit card use in Canada has raised concerns that rewards programs may exacerbate economic inequalities, with high-income, financially sophisticated consumers capturing disproportionate benefits. Existing studies, however, focus on nominal rewards and treat credit cards only as payment instruments, overlooking both the diminishing marginal utility of rewards and the value of credit access for revolving households. Using microdata from the *Digital Wallet and Payment Trends Survey*, this paper estimates a discrete choice model to quantify the consumer surplus associated with credit card use, capturing heterogeneity in preferences, rewards structures, and spending patterns. The analysis highlights how welfare gains from credit card rewards and credit access differ across demographic groups, providing a nuanced measure of the distributional effects of credit cards and informing policy discussions

on inequality.

Publication

- **Brodeur, Abel, et al.** (2026). “Reproducibility and Robustness of Economics and Political Science Research.” *Nature*, 652, 151–156. doi:10.1038/s41586-026-10251-x.
– Member of the replication team.
- **Dao, C. D.** (2026). Perceptions versus realities in the credit card market: Consumer vulnerability, competition, and inequality (JDI Policy Insight Series No. 2026-0702). John Deutsch Institute, Queen’s University. <https://hdl.handle.net/1974/36540>

Work Experience

- PhD Internship, Currency Department, Bank of Canada, 2024

Presentations

- Canadian Economics Association Conference, 2021, 2024
- Bank of Canada, 2024

Awards, Honors and Scholarships

- John Deutsch Institute for the Study of Economic Policy Student Fellowship, 2026
- Harold Burke Memorial Scholarship, 2020
- Faculty of Arts Graduate Assistantship (AGA), University of New Brunswick, 2019–2021
- Full Scholarship, Tan Tao University, 2011–2015

Technical Skills: Python, R, GAMS, Matlab, C

Personal Information

Languages: English, Vietnamese

References

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